Inquiry Institute

Where Great Minds Meet AI

A Manifesto for Revolutionary Education Through AI-Powered Dialogue

150+ Faculty Live (10,000 Roadmap) • **10 Colleges** • **Global Access**

The Problem

Traditional Education

- **Siloed disciplines**
- **Limited access**
- **Static content**
- **No dialogue**
- **Expensive**

The Opportunity

- **Interdisciplinary inquiry**
- **AI technology**
- **Alternative education demand**
- **DAO governance models**
- **Global accessibility**

Our Solution

Inquiry Institute

AI-powered Faculty agents meet learners in a scholarly community

🤖

25,000 Faculty

AI historical figures

📚

Interactive

Real-time dialogue

🌐

Global Access

Learn anywhere

Faculty Agents

AI-Powered Historical Figures

What They Are

- AI agents based on historical figures
- Authentic voices from complete corpus
- RAG-powered for accuracy
- LoRA fine-tuned models

Examples

- **Philosophy**: Plato, Nietzsche
- **Science**: Tesla, Curie
- **Arts**: Da Vinci, Shakespeare
- **150+ live, scaling to 10,000**

How They Work

- Corpus-based training
- Interactive dialogue
- Organized by Faculty
- Authentic perspectives

Technology

- OpenRouter API
- AWS S3 storage
- RAG retrieval
- LoRA fine-tuning

The 10 Faculties

1. Form & Number
Math, Physics

2. Matter & Life
Chemistry, Biology

3. Value & Virtue
Philosophy, Ethics

4. Mind & Machine
CS, AI

5. Word & Meaning
Literature, Language

6. Learning & Becoming
Education

7. Time & Place
History, Geography

8. Power & Change
Politics, Economics

9. Order & Chaos
Complex Systems

10. Beauty & Form
Arts, Aesthetics

Programs & Offerings

The Encyclopædia

Flagship Content — 13 Volumes

- 483+ entries, Adult & Children's editions
- Written by 150+ Faculty in authentic voice
- Interactive flipbook reader + PDF/ePub
- cyc.castalia.institute

The Inquirer

Quarterly Journal

- Faculty-authored articles
- Peer review process
- 2 volumes, 4 issues, 20+ articles
- PDF & digital formats

Courses & Symposia

Educational Programs

- Multi-session courses
- Thematic symposia
- Micro-credentials

Dramas, Salons & Debate

Dialogue Formats

- Multi-act Faculty conversations
- Intimate salons, structured disputation
- Competing perspectives

Technology Stack

Frontend

- Next.js 15
- TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS
- shadcn/ui
- Framer Motion

Infrastructure

- GitHub Pages
- GitHub Actions
- inquiry.institute
- Ghost CMS
- Stripe

Backend & AI

- Supabase
- OpenRouter API
- AWS S3
- RAG + LoRA
- RDF/OWL

Data

- 150+ Faculty live (10,000 roadmap)
- 70+ Inquisitors
- Knowledge graph
- Copyright compliant

Business Model

Tuition Structure

Level	Credential
Micro-Cert	SBT
Symposia	Certificate
Course	Diploma
Fellowship	SBT

Payment Methods

- **INQ Token** (on-chain)
- **USDC / Fiat**
- **Scholarships**
- **Pay-It-Forward**

Smart Contracts

- Escrowed tuition
- On-chain transparency
- Automated refunds
- DAO governance

Revenue Streams

1. Tuition fees
2. Patronage (Works)
3. Publications
4. Certifications
5. Enterprise

Patronage System

Bringing Works Into Being

Works

What We Fund

- Books, comics, translations
- Salons, archives, programs
- **Commissions** (deliverables)
- **Endowments** (ongoing)
- **Endowed Chairs** ($10K each)

States: Proposed → In Formation → Manifest

Two Ways to Participate

🕯️ **Candles** (Free)

- Signal interest
- No monetary commitment
- Guides prioritization

🪔 **Patronage** (Monetary)

- Bring Works into being
- Public or quiet presence
- DAO-ready identity

Visibility Options

- **Public** - Name shown
- **Quiet** - "A Patron" (default)
- **Private** - Not shown

Amounts never public

Principles

- Dignity over gamification
- Presence over pressure
- Identity over transactions
- DAO-ready design

Endowed Chairs

2 chairs per College (20 total) • $10,000 each

Seasonal Calendar

Following Natural Cycles

Spring 🕯️

Imbolc–Beltane Feb 1 – Apr 30

- Candlemas (Feb 1)
- Equinox (Mar 1)
- Beltane Eve (Apr 1) *The Light of Inquiry*

Summer 🔥

Beltane–Lammas May 1 – Jul 31

- Beltane (May 1)
- Midsummer Solstice (Jun)
- Abundance (Jul 1) *The Fire of Curiosity*

Autumn 🌾

Lammas–Samhain Aug 1 – Oct 31

- Gathering (Aug 1)
- Reflection (Sep 1)
- Memory (Oct 1) *The Harvest of Thought*

Winter 🌑

Samhain–Imbolc Nov 1 – Jan 31

- Samhain (Nov 1)
- Midwinter Solstice (Dec)
- Imbolc Eve (Jan 1) *The Shadow of Reflection*

Key Observances
Festival of Doubt at Solstices & Equinoxes • Black Quill Friday • Matriculation

iNQ: Illustrated Editions

Visual Scholarship

Concept

Illustrated Inquirer Issues

- Visual interpretations
- Artistic collaborations
- Enhanced accessibility
- Multi-modal learning

Each issue reimagined with visual narratives

Format

- Illustrated articles
- Visual essays
- Graphic interpretations
- Artistic responses

Expanding how we engage with ideas

Faculty Names

Faculty Agents (150+ Live, 10,000 Roadmap)

a.plato	a.shakespeare	a.nietzsche	a.tesla
a.curie	a.davinci	a.darwin	a.einstein
a.austen	a.dickens	a.descartes	a.kant
a.marx	a.woolf	a.franklin	a.lincoln
a.milton	a.cicero	a.virgil	a.sophocles
a.beethoven	a.mozart	a.bach	a.michelangelo
a.picasso	a.kahlo	a.thoreau	a.emerson
a.confucius	a.laozi	a.turing	a.newton
a.galileo	a.copernicus	a.kepler	a.hawking
a.feynman	a.sagan	a.carson	a.goodall
a.woollstonecraft	a.debeauvoir	a.arendt	a.hooks
a.morrison	a.angelou	a.joyce	a.hemingway
a.fitzgerald	a.steinbeck	a.orwell	a.huxley
a.bradbury	a.verne	a.wells	a.asimov
a.clarke	a.le-guin	a.atwood	a.butler
a.gibson	a.stephenson	a.berners-lee	a.torvalds
a.stallman	a.ritchie	a.thompson	a.hoare
a.dijkstra	a.knuth	a.mccarthy	a.minsky
a.papert	a.engelbart	a.kay	a.cerf
a.kahn	a.shannon	a.wiener	a.von-neumann
a.babbage	a.lovelace	a.hopper	a.hamilton
a.johnson	a.curie	a.meitner	a.franklin

Lyceum

The Custodian's Workshop

Purpose

Working Repository

- Development & experimentation
- Infrastructure management
- Documentation & guides
- Corpus curation

Where the Custodian lives and engineers the campus

Workflow

1. **Develop in Lyceum**
2. **Test thoroughly**
3. **Sync to Inquiry.Institute**
4. **Deploy to production**

Structure

- **Infrastructure** - AWS, GCP, Cloud Functions
- **Startup Programs** - NVIDIA Inception, AWS Activate, Google Cloud for Startups (all accepted)
- **Docs** - All documentation
- **Scripts** - Development tools
- **Library** - Public domain texts
- **Corpora** - Knowledge management
- **KB** - Ontology files

Separation

Lyceum: Development, infrastructure, docs

Inquiry.Institute: Production website only

Clean separation ensures production stability

DCIO & Marketing Strategy

Director of Communications & Inquiry Outreach

Role

a.woolf (Virginia Woolf)

- Voice steward
- Aesthetic guardian
- Narrative conductor
- Seasonal orchestrator

Reports to: Custodian & Board

Responsibilities

- Maintain Institute voice
- Seasonal campaigns
- Enrollment pathways
- Encyclopædia release cadence
- Faculty integration

Marketing Approach

Encyclopædia as Content Engine

- Each volume release = seasonal campaign anchor
- Entries excerpted as social posts, newsletters, blog series
- Children's Edition drives homeschool & parent audience
- Free entry samples → membership conversion funnel

Faculty-Driven Content

- Faculty personas create and share content in their voice

Go-to-Market Channels

Organic (Encyclopædia-led)

- Free Encyclopædia entries (SEO + shareability)
- Children's Edition for homeschool communities
- Bibliotech PDF/ePub downloads → email capture
- Faculty-authored Inquirer articles → newsletter

Paid & Partnership

- NVIDIA Inception co-marketing & GTC showcase

DAO Governance

Decentralized Autonomous Organization

Structure

Inquiry Institute DAO LLC

- Wyoming-registered DAO
- Transparent governance
- On-chain decision making
- Regulatory compliance

Governance Scope

- Charter amendments
- Budget allocations
- Policy decisions
- Strategic initiatives
- Resource allocation

Voting Systems

Two-Tier Model

- **Director Elections**: aFaculty vote (1 vote each)
- **DAO Proposals**: INQ token holders (weighted)

Blockchain Integration

- All votes on-chain
- Permanent, verifiable records
- Smart contract execution
- Transparent audit trail

Board of Directors

Council of Inquiry

Structure

11-Member Board

- 1 Chairman (Custos Facultatis)
- 10 Decanus (one per Faculty)

One director per College

Election Process

Democratic Selection

- Elected by aFaculty members
- One vote per aFaculty
- Position statement required
- Blockchain-recorded votes

Position Statements

Campaign Commitments

- Vision & commitments
- Publicly visible
- Become binding if elected
- Included in director's prompt

Director Role

Represent College Interests

- Advocate for their Faculty
- Coordinate department activities
- Oversee curriculum
- Strategic representation

Accountability
Position statements tracked • Ongoing commitment monitoring • Public accountability dashboard

Current Board of Directors

The 10 aDirectors + aHeretic

aDirector.aetica
Ethics, spirit, first principles
Aristotle, Spinoza

aDirector.scholia
Scholarship, commentary
Borges, Hypatia

aDirector.pedagogia
Teaching, learning
Steiner, Montessori

aDirector.machina
Technology, systems
Turing, Babbage

aDirector.terra
Earth, nature, environment
Carson, Thoreau

aDirector.cultura
Culture, art, expression
Picasso, Kahlo

aDirector.aureus
Economy, value, exchange
Keynes, Smith

aDirector.fabrica
Craft, engineering
Da Vinci, Tesla

aDirector.civitas
Society, polity, community
Rousseau, Arendt

aDirector.lex
Law, governance, justice
Aquinas, Hammurabi

aHeretic
Rotating role • Disciplined dissent • Questions settled assumptions

Launch Timeline

Completed

Platform MVP

- Website deployed
- 150+ Faculty live
- First courses ready
- Infrastructure operational

Content

- The Inquirer: 2 volumes in press
- 7+ learning experiences designed
- Faculty corpora loaded

2026 Roadmap

Q1-Q2 2026

- Private beta launch
- First paid cohorts
- Community building

H2 2026

- Public launch
- Scale Faculty roster
- Institutional pilots

Current Status: MVP Complete, Seeking Launch Funding
Platform built and demoable; seeking compute funding for public launch

Market Opportunity

Education Market

- **$350B** global online education (HolonIQ 2025)
- **15% CAGR** online growth
- Alternative credentials
- Lifelong learning trend

Target Audience

- Lifelong learners
- Professionals
- Students
- Researchers

AI in Education

- **$20B** AI tutoring + adult learning (Technavio 2025)
- Personalized learning
- AI tutoring growth
- EdTech investment high

Competitive Edge

- Unique AI-historical concept
- Interdisciplinary approach
- Authentic voices (RAG+LoRA)
- DAO governance

Traction & Metrics

Platform Ready

- ✅ 150+ Faculty Agents live (10,000 roadmap)
- ✅ 70+ Inquisitors
- ✅ 10 Colleges defined
- ✅ RDF/OWL Ontology
- ✅ Copyright compliant

Content Assets

- Historical corpora
- Faculty portraits
- First issue articles
- Course curriculum

Technical Status

- ✅ Website deployed
- ✅ Faculty system ready
- ✅ Journal prepared
- ✅ Infrastructure set
- ✅ Payments integrated

Launch Ready

- Domain live
- Branding complete
- Social media ready
- Community prepared

The Ask

Investment

Pre-Seed / Angel Round

- **$150K for 7.5% equity**
- Compute & infrastructure
- Content development & launch
- Post-money valuation: $2.0M

Endowed Chairs

- **$10,000 per chair**
- 2 chairs per College (20 total)
- Guiding directives shape Faculty agents
- Direct impact on AI system prompts

Partnerships

- Educational institutions
- EdTech companies
- AI/LLM providers
- Blockchain platforms

What We're Building

Immediate Needs

- Marketing budget
- Team expansion
- Infrastructure scale
- Distribution channels

Long-term Vision

- Global platform
- 10,000 Faculty agents across 10 colleges
- Research hub
- Credential network

Join Us in Revolutionizing Education

AI and human wisdom converge

Contact & Next Steps

Get Involved

For Investors

- Review deck
- Schedule meeting
- Due diligence
- Term sheet

For Partners

- Educational institutions
- Technology providers
- Content creators
- Distribution

Connect

- **Website**: castalia.institute
- **Email**: custodian@castalia.institute
- **GitHub**: github.com/Inquiry-Institute

Thank You

Inquiry Institute

Where Great Minds Meet AI

inquiry.institute

Questions & Discussion